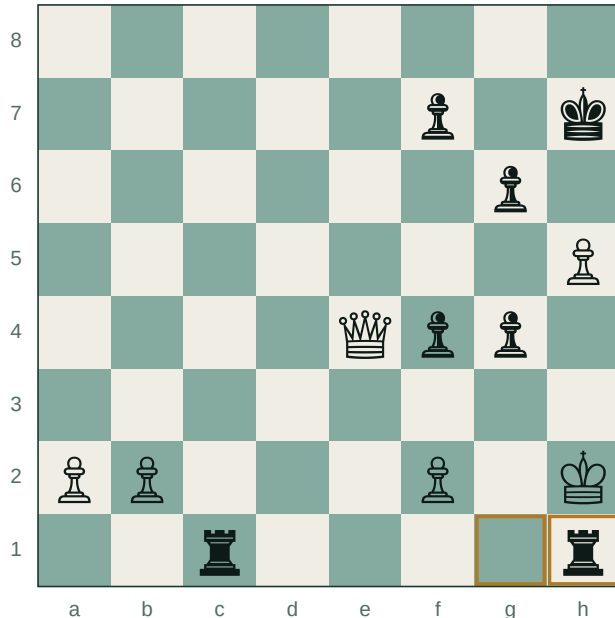


Queen-and-rook endings: White, move 30

Queen-and-rook endings

White to move



Previous move: 29...Rh1+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

30. Qxh1 g3+ 31. fxg3 fxg3+ 32. Kg2

30.Qxh1 The queen captures the rook on h1. Recorded reply: **30...g3+**.

31.fxg3 The pawn captures the pawn on g3. Recorded reply: **31...fxg3+**.

32.Kg2 The king moves from h2 to g2.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 8 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -1 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on h7. Absolute pin: pawn on g6.